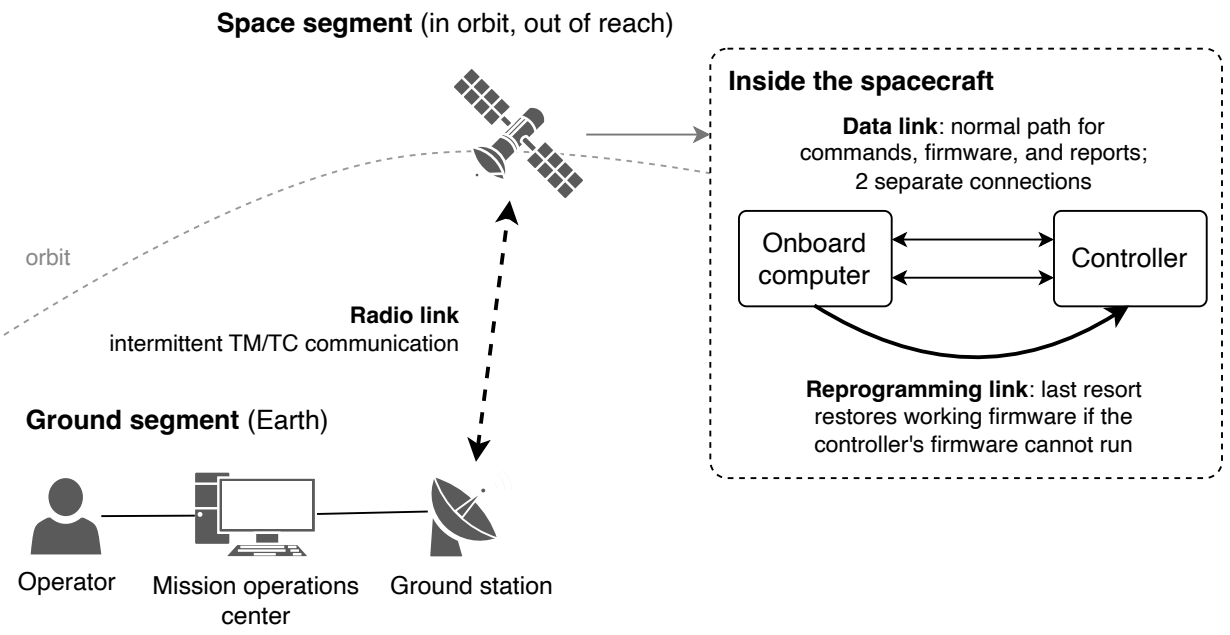
Space segment (in orbit, out of reach)
orbit
Radio link
intermittent TM/TC communication
Ground segment (Earth)
Operator
Mission operations center
Ground station
Inside the spacecraft
Data link: normal path for commands, firmware, and reports; 2 separate connections
Onboard computer
Controller
Reprogramming link: last resort restores working firmware if the controller's firmware cannot run